

A Mornington Peninsula *Summer*

Bay swims at 7 am, long lunches with the doors open, rooms above the water at the tip — the Peninsula at its loudest and most loved.

Eight pages · Six venues · One sample weekend · Updated May 2026

Summer is the busy season — book it like you mean it.

Summer on the Peninsula is the one season everyone knows about. The trade-off is that the rooms are full, the cellar door staff are stretched, and the long lunches need three weeks of notice. The reward is bay swims at sunrise, ocean coast walks under afternoon light, and the rare combination of warm water and serious dining within a 40-minute drive.

This guide skews to venues that scale into the season — places with the room and the kitchen depth to deliver when the booking sheet is full. Six venues, sequenced into a sample two-night plan that puts the heat on the right side of the day.

The six

1. Jackalope Hotel

\$\$\$\$ · RED HILL

A dramatic art-led design hotel set inside a working vineyard, with Doot Doot Doot's eight-metre chandelier overhead

2. Pt. Leo Estate

\$\$\$ · MERRICKS

A sculpture park walk followed by a long bay-view lunch in the glass-walled restaurant

3. Flinders Hotel

\$\$\$ · FLINDERS

A polished village-base stay with proper pub energy downstairs and Bass Strait within easy reach

4. Tedesca Osteria

\$\$\$ · RED HILL

Brigitte Hafner's single-set-menu osteria inside a restored Red Hill farmhouse with the wood oven running all service

5. Hotel Sorrento

\$\$\$ · SORRENTO

A grand old bay-facing pub-hotel whose best rooms still make Sorrento feel gloriously old-school

A sample summer weekend

Friday evening

Drive down before the freeway thickens. Sunset on the bay, casual dinner at the hotel restaurant, in bed early. Saturday will start at 7.

Saturday morning

Bay swim at 7 — the water is warmest in the first hour. Coffee at a Sorrento or Mornington local. Brunch is light; the long lunch is the event.

Saturday afternoon

Long lunch at one of the six. Two-and-a-half hours, bottle on the deck, the wine list paying the room rent. Cabs back to base — driving in summer afternoon traffic is the slow way to lose two hours.

Sunday morning

Ocean coast walk before the sun gets serious. Cape Schanck or Bushrangers Bay. Lunch is a fish and chips on the wharf. Home before the freeway turns into a car park.

Peninsula Insider is independent. Every venue here was visited by the editorial desk. No paid placements. Read the Methodology at peninsulainsider.com.au/methodology.

This guide was produced May 2026. The live site supersedes; check before you book.